

Cloud types

There are ten basic types of clouds. Their names reflect how they look or behave, combining words such as *cirrus* (hair), *stratus* (layer), *cumulus* (heap), and *nimbus* (rain). The cloud types are usually grouped as low-, medium-, and high-level clouds.

Cirrus

Cirrostratus

Cirrocumulus

High-level clouds

20,000 ft
(6,000 m)

Alto cumulus

Medium-level clouds

Altostratus

Stratocumulus

6,500 ft
(2,000 m)

Stratus

Low-level clouds

Cumulus

Nimbostratus

Cumulonimbus

